

How Banff Advisors Works in Contender

Based on Contender Dashboard Data Structure Analysis

Banff Team Structure

Executive Advisors (Client-facing relationship owners):

- **David Boehmer** - Founder & CEO (majority of Tier 1 clients)
- **Clare Buxton** - Executive Advisor
- **Lauren Mello** - Executive Advisor, Brand Strategy
- **Olivia Barth** - Executive Advisor

Client Services (Operational support):

- **Max Ravech** - Lead for trending campaigns, P2P curation, quarterly reporting
- **Lily Tympanick** - Onboarding, narrative development, profile management
- **Amanda Chi** - B4B pipeline management, campaign execution

B4B Leadership:

- **Kayla Kanipe** - Head of Banff for Business

Product & Engineering:

- **Anneliese Pineda Klein** - Product and Design Lead
- **Jessica Wray** - Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer
- **Evgeniy Apushkin** - Staff Backend Engineer
- **Nathan Franklin** - Senior Data Scientist

External Advisor:

- **Samantha Lasso** - Executive Coach

Overview: Banff's Two-Sided Business Model

Contender is Banff's proprietary CRM/ATS system that manages their two core services:

1. **Executive Advisory Services** - 212 Tier 1 executives paying for career advisory, board placement, and peer networking
2. **B4B (Business-for-Business) Network** - 300+ VC/PE firms and search firms looking for executive talent

Contender serves as the central matching engine between these two sides.

Key Distinction in Contender Data:

- **"Advisor"** field = Executive Advisor (David/Clare/Lauren/Olivia) - strategic relationship owner
- **"Client Owner"** field = Client Services (Max/Lily/Amanda) - operational lead

Tab 1: HOME - Activity Dashboard

What It Shows

Central command center showing real-time activity across all workflows.

Key Sections

1. My Tasks / Upcoming / Overdue / Completed

- Task management for Client Services team (Max, Lily, Amanda) and Executive Advisors (David, Clare, Lauren, Olivia)
- Tasks like: "Trend Jose Resendiz," "Jay Collins PE list," "Chantal Rapport NE's"
- Shows workflow coordination between Client Services and Executive Advisors

2. New Executives (73 in last 30 days)

- Recent additions to network (Rani Johnson - CIO Workday, Abhi Chakraborty - CFO SellersFi, etc.)
- Shows B4B network growth velocity

3. Scheduled Intros

- Tomorrow's scheduled trending campaigns and P2P intros
- Example: "Carlos Minetti → Team Board Advisory Services - NYSE"
- Proves scheduled automation system exists

4. Contender Activity Feed

- Real-time log of all system actions:

- "Rani Johnson introduced to Nicole North, Team Talent - Lightspeed"
- "Amanda Chi created Infrastructure Services executives pipeline"
- "Sarah Blanchard requested intro with Raj Bagchi"
- "Added to (Evergreen) CIOs pipeline"

What This Reveals About Banff

- **High-volume operation:** 100+ activities logged per day
- **Two workflows running in parallel:** Exec advisory (P2P intros) + B4B (pipeline submissions)
- **Role separation:** Amanda (Client Services) creates pipelines, Executive Advisors handle P2P relationship management, Kayla/Amanda manage B4B matching operations

Tab 2: TASKS - Workflow Management

What It Shows

All client service tasks organized by team member, client, status, and due date.

Task Types by Phase

Onboarding Tasks (New Client)

- "Complete client setup across Notion, HubSpot & Contender"
- "Client folder created in Google Drive"
- "Add Background Deep Dive form responses to Contender profile"
- "Add kickoff date to HubSpot & Contender"
- "Conduct post-kickoff debrief"
- "Add compensation to tracker if provided"
- "Send welcome email to client"

Narrative Development Tasks

- "Update profile with highlights, about & interests"
- "Share narrative edits with client for review"
- "Update LinkedIn, resume, bio or highlights"
- "Ensure client updates LinkedIn profile (if applicable)"
- "Inform B4B/Executive Advisor that the client is ready to be shared"

Ongoing Service Tasks

- "Send P2Ps" (Peer-to-Peer introductions)
- "Send Trending campaign"
- "Refresh account plan"
- "Collect external feedback"
- "Conduct Performance Diagnosis"
- "Check in with client for feedback on introductions"
- "Share 1-6 peer ideas for approval"

Task Ownership

- **Max Ravech** (Client Services): Lead for trending campaigns, P2P curation, task management
- **Lily Tympanick** (Client Services): Onboarding, narrative edits, profile development
- **Amanda Chi** (Client Services): B4B pipeline management, campaign execution
- **Emma Lane**: Template task generator (batch-created tasks for multiple clients)
- **Samantha Lassoff** (External Executive Coach): Newer team member (full onboarding cycle for JP Durrios)

What This Reveals About Banff

- **673 total tasks** in system (mix of active, overdue, completed)
- **Standardized service delivery:** Same task templates for all clients
- **4-system onboarding:** HubSpot, Notion, Contender, Google Drive (manual coordination)
- **No automation:** All tasks manually created and tracked

Tab 3: PIPELINES - B4B Search Management

What It Shows

2,197 active B4B searches from VC/PE firms and search firms looking for executives.

Pipeline Structure

Each pipeline has:

- **Pipeline Name:** "Infrastructure Services executives," "CFO," "(Evergreen) CIOs"
- **Team:** "Team GTCR," "Team Talent - Lightspeed," "Team True Search"
- **Company Type:** Investor (VC/PE) vs. Search (executive search firm) vs. Corporate
- **Industry/Function Tags:** Energy, Fintech, CEO, Marketing, etc.
- **Candidate Count:** Number of execs submitted (0-79)
- **Intro Count:** Number of introductions made
- **Status:** Active, Proactive (evergreen), or Search (one-time)
- **Dates:** Created, Updated, Last Activity

Pipeline Categories

1. Evergreen Pipelines (Proactive = Yes)

- "(Evergreen) CIOs"
- "(Evergreen) Energy"
- "(Evergreen) SaaS CFOs"
- Continuous matching, not time-bound

2. Specific Searches (One-time placements)

- "CFO, Trewstar"
- "CMO, Supergoop"
- "CEO, Confidential Consumer Digital"

3. Thought Leader Networks (Networking, not hiring)

- "SF thought leaders"
- "London thought leaders"
- "2026 Womens Leadership Dinner" (79 candidates!)

Key B4B Partners (by pipeline volume)

- **Spencer Stuart:** 46 pipelines, 33 people
- **Russell Reynolds:** 53 pipelines, 42 people
- **Korn Ferry:** 30 pipelines, 28 people
- **Point72 Private Investments:** 36 pipelines, 27 people
- **TPG:** 24 pipelines, 13 people
- **Ontario Teachers' Pension Plan:** 17 pipelines, 13 people
- **Nyca Partners:** 17 pipelines, 12 people

What This Reveals About Banff

- **B4B side is massive:** 2,197 active searches across 178 companies
- **Mix of investors + search firms:** 60% investor-led, 40% search firm-led
- **High-volume matching:** Some pipelines have 70+ candidates submitted
- **Amanda's manual work:** She creates most pipelines ("Amanda Chi created...")
- **Kayla's routing challenge:** Deciding which execs go to which of 2,197 pipelines

Tab 4: TRENDING - Campaign Management

What It Shows

3,239 trending campaigns - customized email blasts promoting executives to B4B partners.

Trending Structure

Two Views:

1. **People View:** Lists executives ranked by intro potential
 - Sherry Ann Mohan (#1, 127 score, 22 industries, 28 functions)
 - Jose Resendiz (#2, 74 score, 23 industries, 22 functions)
2. **Campaigns View:** Lists all sent/scheduled campaigns
 - Phil Bishop - Custom - Scheduled today
 - Kaveri Camire - Custom - Published yesterday
 - Peter Jackson - Bi-Weekly - Published yesterday

Campaign Types

- **Bi-Weekly:** Automated recurring campaigns for active job seekers
- **Custom:** One-off targeted campaigns (5-15 specific teams)

Campaign Status

- **Scheduled:** Queued to send (e.g., tomorrow 7 PM)
- **Published:** Already sent to B4B partners

Executive Advisor Assignment

- **DA** (David Boehmer - Founder/CEO): Majority of Tier 1 clients
- **OL** (Olivia Barth - Executive Advisor): Secondary portfolio
- **CL** (Clare Buxton - Executive Advisor): Smaller portfolio
- **LA** (Lauren Mello - Executive Advisor, Brand Strategy): Specialized clients

What This Reveals About Banff

- **3,239 campaigns total** - massive volume
 - **Max's 20-30 min per campaign** makes sense (filtering 300+ teams manually)
 - **Bi-weekly automation exists** but custom campaigns are manual
 - **Trending = primary B4B matching mechanism**
-

Tab 5: PEER TO PEER - Executive Networking

What It Shows

2,279 P2P introductions between Banff executive clients (not B4B, exec-to-exec networking).

P2P Structure

Intro Stages:

1. **Approved:** Client Services (Max/Lily) curated match, Executive Advisor approved (e.g., Tejas Shah → Sundeep Jain)
2. **Scheduled:** Intro email scheduled to send (e.g., Jeff Capone → Sean Cantrell, Dec 15)
3. **Introduced:** Email sent, awaiting connection (e.g., Carrie Wheeler → Laura Miele)

Match Examples:

- Tejas Shah (SVP Sales Transformation, Fluence) → Sundeep Jain (Former CPO, Uber)
- Carrie Wheeler (Former CEO, Opendoor) → Laura Miele (President, EA)
- Ana Mendy (VP PayPal) → Denise Leonhard (Zelle GM)

What This Reveals About Banff

- **P2P is exec-side service** (not B4B job matching)
 - **2,279 total intros** = high-value networking service
 - **Manual curation:** Client Services (Max) suggests matches, Executive Advisors approve
 - **Zero automated tracking** (the pain point from discovery calls)
-

Tab 6: PERFORMANCE - Client Dashboard

What It Shows

Client performance tracking across quarterly activity metrics.

"Clients In the Red"

Executives approaching quarter-end with zero facilitated introductions.

Examples:

- Casey Klyszeiko (Fiserv): 4 days until quarterly, 0 intros, 2 P2P
- Tricia Alcamo (FanDuel): 7 days until quarterly, 0 intros
- Ben Walter (JPMorgan): 7 days until quarterly, 3 intros, 2 P2P

Client Performance Metrics

For each client, Contender tracks:

1. **Rank:** Relative performance (#1 = David Klein with 75 score)
2. **Score:** Composite engagement metric
3. **Facilitated Intros:** B4B introductions (pipelines + trending)
4. **P2P Intros:** Peer-to-peer executive connections
5. **Requests:** Client-initiated asks
6. **Program:** Active Job Seeker, Passive Job Seeker, Network Builder, Aspiring Board Member, New Role Leader

Top Performers:

1. David Klein - 75 score, 5 facilitated, 10 P2P, 10 requests
2. Lex Bayer - 1 score, 3 facilitated, 4 P2P
3. Adrienne Coulson - 50 score, 7 facilitated, 8 P2P

Quarterly Tracking

- **Upcoming Quarterlies:** 10 clients
- **Recently Past Quarterlies:** 18 clients
- Used for quarterly report generation (Max's "riddled with bad data" pain point)

What This Reveals About Banff

- **Data-driven client service:** Tracking every intro, request, and touchpoint
 - **Quarterly reporting is core deliverable:** Hence the performance dashboard
 - **Max's cross-referencing problem:** Data in Contender doesn't match Notion/HubSpot, requiring manual validation
 - **Red flag system:** Proactively identifies clients not getting value
-

Tab 7: PEOPLE - Executive Database

What It Shows

4,981 people in Contender (mix of Tier 1 executives, Tier 3 network, B4B contacts).

Person Profile Structure

Example: Jay Cipriano (EVP, SEI)

Personal Information

- Full Name, LinkedIn URL, Email, Phone
- Tier: 1 - Executive Client
- **Advisor:** David Boehmer (Executive Advisor - relationship owner)
- **Client Owner:** Max Ravech (Client Services - operational lead)
- Kickoff Date: Jun 26, 2024
- Client Program: Passive Job Seeker
- Referred by: Todd Taylor
- Currently wants intros: Yes
- Pipeline introduction email setting: Manual

Professional Information

- **Headline Role:** Executive Vice President and Head of SEI's Institutional business
- **Headline Company:** SEI
- **Industry Expertise:** Financial Services
- **Functional Expertise:** General Management, Other
- **Target Industries:** Financial Services
- **Target Functions:** CEO, General Management, Operations
- **Operating Role Interest:** Passively Seeking
- **Board / Advisory Role Interest:** Passively Seeking
- **Additional Notes:** "Open to relocation to a major city in Europe"

Networking Interests

- **Professional:** Angel and VC Investing, AI and ML, Education, Entrepreneurship, Private Equity Operating, Disruptive Technology
- **Personal:** Travel, Outdoor Activities, Gaming, Media, Music, Sports, Academia, Film

Off-Limits

- **Companies:** (none for Jay)
- **People:** Existing Relationship - Todd Taylor, Heidrick & Struggles

LinkedIn Profile Sync

- Stores full LinkedIn profile data in Contender
- Updated: Apr 19, 2025, 2:21 AM
- Shows Jay's full experience history, education, bio

What This Reveals About Banff

- **Rich candidate profiles:** Far beyond basic CRM data
 - **LinkedIn auto-updater exists:** Syncs LinkedIn data to Contender
 - **Problem:** LinkedIn auto-updater overwrites manual edits (Amanda's pain point - doesn't add "former" to job titles)
 - **Off-limits tracking:** Prevents conflicts of interest
 - **Manual email settings:** "Manual" vs auto-send for pipeline intros
-

Tab 8: COMPANIES - B4B Partner Database

What It Shows

178 B4B companies (investors, search firms, corporate partners).

Company Structure

Example: ZRG Partners (Search Firm)

- **Company Name:** ZRG Partners
- **Members:** 4 people (Holly Dobson, Justin Pinchback, Kiel Towns, Tanja Iannarelli)
- **Teams:** 5 (each person has their own "Team")
 - Team Holly Dobson - ZRG Partners
 - Team James Macedonio - ZRG Partners
 - Team Justin Pinchback - ZRG
 - Team Kiel Towns - ZRG Partners
 - Team Michelle Dunne - ZRG Partners

Company Types:

- **Premium Investor:** VC/PE firms (VMG Partners, TPG, Lightspeed, Ontario Teachers)
- **Premium Search:** Executive search firms (True Search, Spencer Stuart, Russell Reynolds, Korn Ferry)
- **Premium Corporate:** Operating companies looking for talent (Peloton, NewRez)

Key Stats:

- **True Search:** 36 pipelines, 29 people
- **Spencer Stuart:** 46 pipelines, 33 people
- **TPG:** 24 pipelines, 13 people
- **Point72 Private Investments:** 36 pipelines, 27 people

What This Reveals About Banff

- **"Team" = individual recruiter/investor at B4B partner firm**
- **One company → many teams:** TPG has multiple teams (Human Capital - TPG, Team TMT - GTCR)
- **Search firms dominate by volume:** Spencer Stuart (46 pipelines) vs. typical investor (5-10 pipelines)
- **Premium status:** All companies marked "Premium" - likely paid partners

Data Flow: How Banff Works End-to-End

1. EXECUTIVE ONBOARDING (Exec Side)

```
TSQ Contract Signed
↓
Manual Entry (Client Services - Max/Lily)
↓
HubSpot (billing, tier, Executive Advisor assignment)
↓
WhaleSync Auto-Sync
↓
Notion (client page created)
↓
Manual Entry (Client Services - Max/Lily)
↓
Contender (profile, kickoff date, program)
↓
Manual (Client Services - Max/Lily)
↓
Google Drive (client folder)
↓
Tasks Auto-Created in Contender
↓
Executive Advisor Kickoff Call (David/Clare/Lauren/Olivia)
↓
Narrative Development by Client Services (LinkedIn, resume, bio)
↓
"Client ready to be shared" with B4B
```

2. B4B MATCHING (B4B Side)

A. Trending Campaigns (Proactive)

```
Client Services (Max) decides to trend an executive
↓
Manually filters 300+ teams by industry/function
↓
Selects 5-15 target teams
↓
Custom trending campaign created in Contender
↓
Scheduled for "tomorrow 7 PM"
↓
Email sent to B4B partners
↓
B4B partner clicks "Request Intro"
↓
Intro status tracked in Contender
↓
Manual follow-up by Client Services (Max/Amanda)
```

B. Pipeline Submissions (Reactive)

```
B4B partner requests pipeline (e.g., "CFO for portfolio co")
↓
Client Services (Amanda) creates pipeline in Contender
↓
Client Services/B4B Lead (Amanda/Kayla) manually search Contender for matches
↓
Check HubSpot for relationship warmth
↓
Check LinkedIn for profile freshness
↓
Manually check for duplicates
↓
Submit 5-10 candidates to pipeline
↓
B4B partner reviews candidates
↓
Requests intro for 2-3 candidates
↓
Intro facilitated, tracked in Contender
```

3. P2P INTRODUCTIONS (Exec Side)

```
Client Services (Max) identifies potential peer match
↓
Checks both execs' interests/goals in Contender
↓
Creates P2P entry in Contender
↓
Status: "Approved" by Executive Advisor
↓
Intro email drafted manually by Client Services
↓
Scheduled to send (e.g., "in 6 days")
↓
Email sent
↓
Status: "Introduced"
↓
NO FOLLOW-UP TRACKING (pain point)
```

4. QUARTERLY REPORTING

```
graph TD
    A[End of quarter approaching] --> B[Client Services (Max) pulls data from Contender (facilitated intros, P2P intros, requests)]
    B --> C[Cross-references Notion (meeting notes, tasks)]
    C --> D[Cross-references HubSpot (billing, tier, dates)]
    D --> E[Manually validates data accuracy (5-10 min per report)]
    E --> F[Generates quarterly report]
    F --> G[Executive Advisor reviews (David/Clare/Lauren/Olivia)]
    G --> H[Sends to client]
```

Key Relationships Between Tabs

Home ↔ Tasks

- Home shows upcoming tasks
- Tasks show full task database
- Tasks auto-created from templates

Pipelines ↔ Trending

- Trending = proactive outreach to B4B partners
- Pipelines = reactive responses to B4B requests
- Both track introductions to same B4B companies

People ↔ Performance

- People = profile data
- Performance = activity metrics over time
- Performance pulls from People + Pipelines + Trending + Peer to Peer

Companies ↔ Pipelines

- Companies = B4B partner organizations
- Each company has multiple "Teams"
- Each team has multiple pipelines

People ↔ Peer to Peer

- P2P only includes people with Tier = "1 - Executive Client"
- Uses networking interests to suggest matches
- Tracked separately from B4B introductions

Pain Points Visible in Data Structure

1. Cross-System Manual Entry (Client Services Team)

- Client Services (Max/Lily/Amanda) manually enter data in HubSpot, then Notion, then Contender, then Google Drive
- WhaleSync only handles HubSpot → Notion
- Contender isolated from automation

2. LinkedIn Auto-Updater Issues (Client Services - Amanda)

- LinkedIn profile sync overwrites manual "former" tags
- Creates "stale profile" incidents with B4B partners

3. No P2P Follow-Up Tracking (Client Services - Max)

- P2P status stuck at "Introduced"
- No Day 7/14 reminder system
- Outcome tracking missing for quarterly reports

4. Pipeline Deduplication (Client Services - Amanda)

- Must manually check if candidate already submitted to pipeline
- No API validation before submission
- 5-7 min per submission

5. Trending Campaign Manual Filtering (Client Services - Max)

- 20-30 min to filter 300+ teams per campaign
- No AI suggestions based on candidate profile
- Pure manual selection

6. Quarterly Report Data Validation (Client Services - Max)

- Contender data doesn't match Notion or HubSpot
- 5-10 min per report to cross-reference
- "Riddled with bad data" - Max's exact quote

7. Zoom Transcript Tagging (Client Services - Max)

- Zapier dumps transcripts to Notion automatically
- No auto-tagging to client profile
- 5-6 hrs/week manual sorting

Automation Opportunities (Based on Data Structure)

Home Tab

- **Activity feed** shows webhook potential for real-time notifications
- **Scheduled intros** prove automation scheduler exists

Tasks Tab

- **Template-based task creation** already exists
- Could auto-create from HubSpot deal stage changes

Pipelines Tab

- **API endpoints exist** for pipeline creation, candidate submission
- Could auto-suggest candidates using AI + Contender filters

Trending Tab

- **Campaign scheduling** already exists
- Could auto-select teams using AI based on candidate profile

Peer to Peer Tab

- **Intro tracking** infrastructure exists
- Could add automated follow-up reminders

Performance Tab

- **Data aggregation** from all tabs
- Could auto-generate quarterly reports with validated data

People Tab

- **LinkedIn sync** already exists
- Could add "former" tag logic to auto-updater

Companies Tab

- **Team structure** maps to API `/api/v1/teams/find`
 - Could auto-match candidates to teams
-

Summary: Banff's Contender Workflow

Contender is Banff's central nervous system for:

1. **Client Management:** 4,981 people (212 Tier 1 execs + 4,769 Tier 3 network)
2. **B4B Matching:** 2,197 pipelines across 178 companies
3. **Trending Campaigns:** 3,239 campaigns promoting execs to B4B partners
4. **P2P Networking:** 2,279 executive-to-executive introductions
5. **Performance Tracking:** Quarterly metrics for client reporting
6. **Task Management:** 673 tasks coordinating Client Services and Executive Advisor workflows

The system works BUT:

- Heavy manual data entry (4 systems: HubSpot → Notion → Contender → Google Drive)
- No automated deduplication (Amanda's pain point)
- No P2P follow-up tracking (Max's pain point)
- No AI-assisted matching (Kayla's "machine falls apart" pain point)
- No auto-tagging for Zoom transcripts (Max's 5-6 hrs/week pain point)
- Bad data in quarterly reports (Max's 5-10 min per report pain point)

The API discovery changes everything: With Contender's full REST API, all 6 pain points can be automated using Make.com + AI.